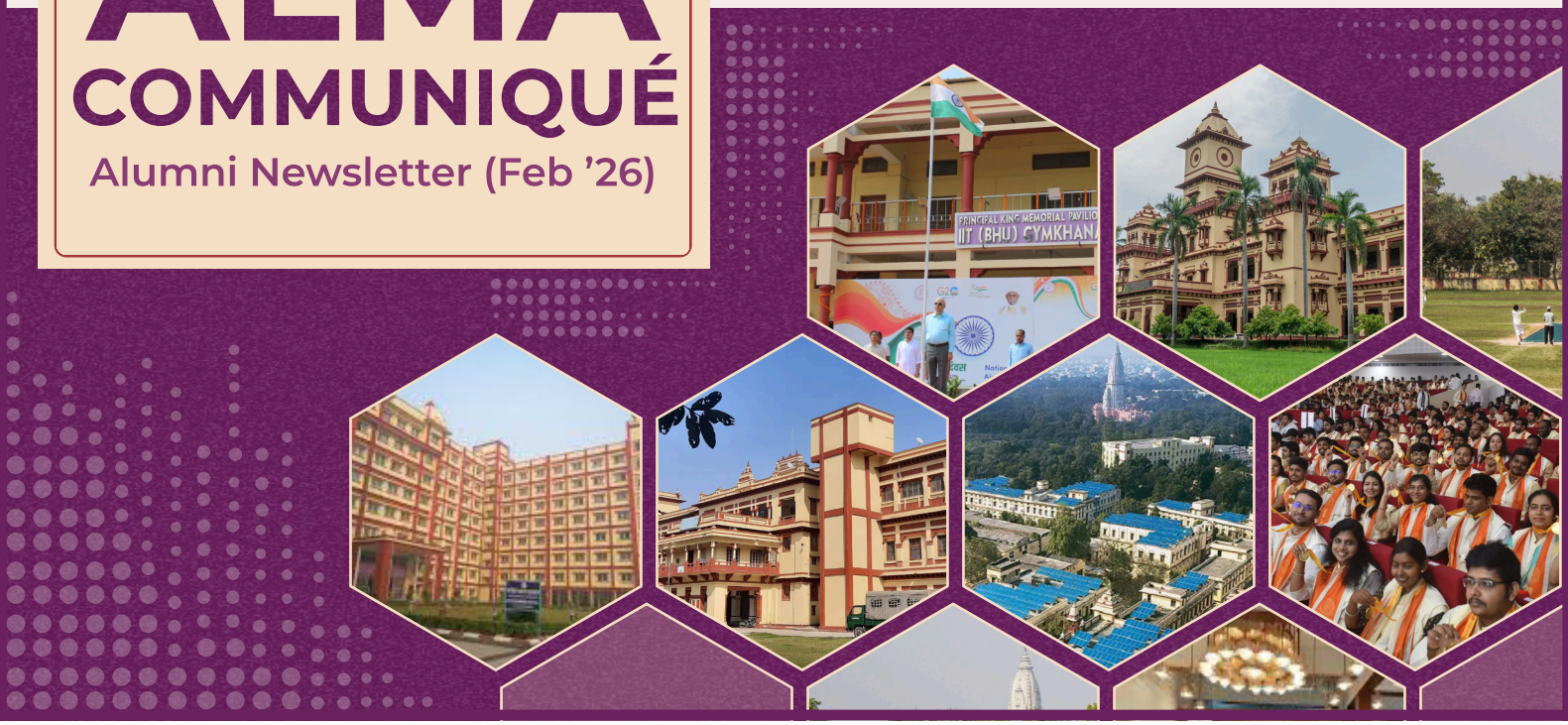
ALMA COMMUNIQUÉ

Alumni Newsletter (Feb '26)

CELEBRATING CENTENARY
100 years
IIT (BHU) VARANASI

STUDENT ALUMNI INTERACTION CELL, IIT (BHU), VARANASI



Institute Updates



1. Forty years after graduating, the Batch of 1986 returned to the Institute to celebrate their Ruby Jubilee Reunion, as alumni and their families gathered from across India and around the world to reconnect and relive their student days. The formal gathering on 2 February 2026 was graced by the Hon'ble Director Prof. Amit Patra and Dean (Resource & Alumni), Prof. Hiralal Pramanik addressing the batch, along with faculty members who had mentored the batch. The event began with traditional ceremonies, followed by a moment of remembrance for departed professors and alumni. During the reunion, walked along familiar campus paths, and shared memories over conversations and *chai*. The event concluded with strengthened bonds and a renewed sense that the Institute will always remain an integral part of their lives.



2. Jagriti '26, the annual socio-awareness festival organised by the Social Service Council (SSC), was held at IIT (BHU), Varanasi, from 6–8 February 2026. The event featured competitions, awareness campaigns, and interactive sessions addressing various social issues. Highlights of the event include the Social Awareness Tunnelan immersive installation designed to highlight real-life social issues through powerful visuals and narratives, along with talks by Group Captain Angad Pratap, Mrs. Sonal Goel, Captain Akhilesh Saxena, and Mr. Mohit Tyagi. The festival concluded with 'Resonance', a peaceful pronite that showed a responsible form of celebration.



3. The Batch of 1976 returned to their alma mater, IIT (BHU) Varanasi, for a historic Golden Jubilee Reunion from 25 to 27 February 2026. Over 85 distinguished alumni and their families traveled from around the globe to celebrate their 50 years of friendship and professional success. The formal gathering was held on 26 February 2026, graced by the Hon'ble Director Prof. Amit Patra, Vice-Chancellor of BHU, Prof. Ajit Kumar Chaturvedi, and Dean (Resource & Alumni), Prof. Hiralal Pramanik along with alumni leaders and respected faculty members who had mentored the batch during their student years. The session featured 'Nostalgia 76,' reflecting on the batch's journey and contributions to the Institute's global legacy. The reunion concluded with the presentation of a Golden Jubilee Memento, marking a heartfelt celebration of memories, gratitude, and the enduring bond between the alumni and their alma mater.



4. The Department of Humanistic Studies IIT (BHU), Varanasi, organised the International Symposium on 'SDGs through Hindu Worldviews: Spiritual Care in a VUCA–BANI World' under SPARC from 25 to 26 February 2026. The event featured keynote addresses exploring themes such as spirituality and sustainability, ethical leadership, spiritual care, and the relevance of Hindu worldviews in addressing the complexities of a VUCA–BANI world. A key highlight of the symposium was the signing of an MoU between the Department of Humanistic Studies, and Vrije Universiteit, Amsterdam for international collaboration, and academic exchange in ethics and sustainable development. The symposium concluded with a commitment to advancing interdisciplinary research, integrating spiritual wisdom with contemporary development.

To explore more on the Reunions this month, please hover over to the Creative Section this edition, on Page 4

Internship/Placement Updates

The Training and Placement Cell at IIT (BHU), with the continued support of students, successfully facilitated the placement and internship processes for the academic year 2025–26. In February 2026, a total of 1280 placement offers, including Pre-Placement Offers (PPOs), have been secured. Additionally, 475 internship offers have been received, showcasing the abundant opportunities extended to students by a wide range of esteemed companies.

The highest internship stipend reached Rs. 11,00,000 per month, while the average stipend stood at Rs. 1,18,783 per month. The highest salary package offered was Rs. 1,67,00,000 per annum, with the average package being Rs. 29,82,133 per annum.

Offers were received from various reputed companies like Google, Microsoft, Goldman Sachs, Qualcomm, Uber, Oracle, JPMC, Amazon, Texas Instruments, Adobe, Deutsche Bank, Schlumberger, Tata Steel, Infosys, Axis Bank, Visa, American Express, Flipkart, Nvidia, D. E. Shaw, AQR Capital, Cohesity, Intuit, PhonePe, and many others, reflecting the strong industry connect and academic excellence of the Institute.

Research and Development

With its ongoing R&D efforts, IIT (BHU) is playing a pivotal role in driving impactful contributions to the global research landscape. Between 1 February 2026 and 28 February 2026, a total of 9 patents were filed, and 7 patents were granted. Progress in research continues to drive new developments.

Patents filed in February

Title	Faculty	Filing Date
A Deployable Shelter Assembly	Dr. Ayan Haldar, Abhijeet Kumar	04/02/2026
A System for Generating a Digital Twin of Road Networks	Dr. Navin Singh Rajput	05/02/2026
Inter-Serpentine Flow Field for a Fluid-Electrochemical Cell and Method Thereof	Dr. Raveendra Gundlapalli, Mr. Gaurav Jaiswal	05/02/2026
Contrast Agents, Its Process of Preparation and Applications Thereof	Dr. Rajendra Prasad Meena	09/02/2026
Transformer-Less Single-Source Switched-Capacitor Boost Multilevel Power Inverter	Prof. Ranjit Mahanty, Dr. V. N. Lal, Arya Singh	24/02/2026
Recycling of Rice Husk Ash and Blast Furnace Slag into Insulating Porous Ceramics	Dr. Subrata Panda, Md. Arif, Vivek Kumar Saroj	24/02/2026
Method for Fabricating Flexible Electromagnetically Transparent Composite Panels	Dr. Ravi Panwal, Vipin Chandra	24/02/2026
An Obstacle Avoidance and Autonomous Soft Landing System	Dr. Shyam Kamal, Baby Diana, Animesh Srivastava, Vinay Pandey, Eram Taslima	28/02/2026
An IoT-Based Evapotranspiration Measurement and Irrigation Control System and Method Thereof	Dr. Preasenjit Chanak, Mr. Priyanshu Chaurasiya, Er. Indu Bhushan Bhagat, Dr. V. K. Chandola, Dr. S. K. Singh	28/02/2026

Patents granted in February

Title	Faculty	Patent Number
A Nanocomposite for Wastewater Treatment and a Method of Preparation Thereof	Dr. Vishal Mishra, Prof. Abha Mishra, Sonam Mishra	580530
A Biosensor for Detection of an Analyte and a Method of Fabrication Thereof	Dr. Ashish Kumar Mishra, Priyanka Jangra	580609
A Polymeric Nano-Hydrogel Composition and a Method of Preparation Thereof	Dr. Pradip Paik, Gurmeet Singh, Divya Parek, Sukanya Patra, Prem Shankar Gupta, Desh Deepak Yadav, Kirti Wasnik	580859
A Transdermal Drug Delivery System and a Method of Preparation Thereof	Dr. Ruchi Chawla, Gajanan Pawar	581653
A Polymeric Nano-Formulation and a Method of Preparation Thereof	Dr. M. S. Muthu, Mr. Abhishesh Kumar Mehata, Ms. Jyoti Bonlawar, Mr. Aseem Setia	581738
An Anti-Cancerous Nanocomposition and a Method of Preparation Thereof	Dr. M. S. Muthu, Mr. Abhishesh Kumar Mehata, Dr. Manoj Kumar, Mr. Aseem Setia	581769
A Broadband Metasurface Based Circularly Polarized Patch Antenna	Deepak Ram, Amit Kumar Singh, Somak Bhattacharya	582004

Additionally, 5 projects were officially sanctioned, with a cumulative funding amounting to Rs. 1,50,92,503.

Projects sanctioned in February

Title of Project	Name of Funding agency	Period of the Project Sanction	Total cost of Project in Rs.
Crowd Management and Heat Stress Mitigation in Temple Precincts of Varanasi	MHT	02 years	13,00,000
Sustainable Blood Supply Chain with Reverse Logistics for Blood Redistribution	SustAlt	03 years	18,15,000
2 Mercaptobenzothiazole Amide Based Small Molecule Activators of PARKIN for the Treatment of Parkinson's Disease	ICMR	03 years	81,68,503
Privacy-Preserving Federated Fraud Detection in Finance	DST	05 years	35,00,000
3D Printing of Bone Derived Hydrogel Based Vascularized Scaffold with Mesenchymal Stem Cells for Enhanced Osteogenesis: Evaluating Regeneration in Different Bone Defect Models	ICMR	03 years	3,09,000

Media Section



Environ-friendly tech to produce clean metal from complex iron ores

Times News Network

Varanasi: Scientists at IIT-BHU have developed a new and cleaner technology to extract metal from complex iron ores, and the innovation was granted a patent. This technology causes significantly less pollution compared to conventional methods and has the potential to greatly reduce carbon emissions from the iron and steel industry.

The research was carried out under the leadership of Prof Girija Shankar Mahobia of Metallurgical Engineering department along with Biswajit Mishra and Lakkoju Sankara Rao.

Prof Mahobia said that steel is widely used in buildings, bridges, railways, vehicles, machinery and household products. However, conventional steelmaking is highly energy-intensive and contributes nearly 7-8% of global carbon dioxide emissions. Producing steel through coal-based processes releases about 2 tonnes of CO_2 per tonne of steel.

Another major challenge is the declining availability of high-grade iron ores in India. The ores that are now available often contain less iron and more impurities. They also include useful metals such as nickel (Ni) and chromium (Cr), but conventional technologies find it difficult to recover them efficiently. This new technology addresses these challenges.

Prof Mahobia explained that the process completely avoids the use of coal or coke. Instead, hydrogen gas is used. Hydrogen helps extract iron without introducing impurities into the metal and makes greenhouse gas emissions nearly 0. In this process, fine iron ore particles are first made into pellets (small spherical pieces). These pellets are then placed in a controlled environment and exposed to hydrogen gas, which removes oxygen from the ore and produces clean iron. Upon further heating, the metal and waste (slag) separate naturally, forming small, pure metal nuggets.

The quality of the metal produced includes iron (Fe) 97.8%, nickel: 0.7-0.9%, and chromium: around 1%. These elements make steel stronger and more durable. Impurity levels are very low—carbon, sulphur, and silicon are present in minimal amounts. This reduces the need for further refining. The technology also ensures that valuable metals like iron, nickel, and chromium are not lost in slag but are recovered in usable form.

Congratulating the team, the IIT-BHU director Prof Amit Patra said that the research demonstrates how the institute is developing environment-friendly and useful technologies for the country. This new hydrogen-based technology is a major step towards lower pollution, reduced energy use, and better utilisation of resources.

IIT-BHU researchers develop new method to produce clean metal from complex iron ores



IIT-BHU alumni donate ₹57L to develop infra

Times News Network

Varanasi: Alumni of the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT), BHU Varanasi of the 1978 batch announced Rs 57 lakh for the 'Gurudakshina Project' to support infrastructure development during their Golden Jubilee Reunion on Thursday.

The 3-day event, held from Feb 20 to 22, saw participation of over 85 alumni from across India and abroad, along with their family members. Addressing the alumni, director Prof Amit Patra highlighted rapid progress made by the institute over the past decade, including expansion of modern infrastructure, growth in research output and initiatives in emerging domains such as MedTech and AgriTech.

The Vice-Chancellor of BHU, Prof AJR Kumar Chaturvedi, who attended as guest of honour, underlined the unique and symbiotic relationship between BHU and IIT-BHU. He noted that collaborative efforts in medicine, agriculture and interdisciplinary research contributed meaningfully to society and nation-building. Relationship between BHU and IIT-BHU is rooted in shared values and a common vision for national development. "Our alumni community continues to inspire us through their global achievements and their unwavering emotional and institutional connect," he said. Dean of resource and alumni affairs Prof Hiralal Pramanik acknowledged the remarkable contributions of the 1976 batch in the fields of science, technology and leadership, and thanked them for their continued mentorship and support to the institute.

In a significant announcement, the batch declared a contribution of Rs 57 lakh under the 'Gurudakshina Project' to support institutional development.

IIT-BHU alumni donate Rs. 57 lakh to develop infra

Student Updates



The Film and Media Council gained momentum this month, with its clubs actively engaging audiences and recording strong participation across social media. The Photography Club launched a new magazine to showcase its creativity, while the Animation Club organized a workshop on animation fundamentals for freshers. The Design Club introduced a Winter Design Challenge encouraging participants to explore new ideas. The Outreach Club presented a reflective skit reminding audiences that 14 February marks the sacrifice and bravery of the CRPF heroes in the Pulwama attack. The Cine Club presented their short film *Saawariya* and also presented 'Postcard from Banaras', a collection of clips capturing the life of Banaras and its ghats, while the Media Club engaged freshers through an interactive campus survey.



The Social Service Council, IIT (BHU) Varanasi, made its debut participation in an outstation fest by attending The National Social Summit at IIT Roorkee. A contingent of 20 members represented the council in events including hackathons, case study competitions, action plan presentations, MUN, and debating. The team actively engaged in the competitions and interactions during the summit, leaving a positive impression on participants and organizers. The contingent received appreciation from students and the organizing committee for its enthusiastic participation. This participation marked the beginning of SSC's outfest journey, which the council aims to continue in the coming years.

Events

Gram Mela



Sahyog Club under the Social Service Council organized Gram Mela at Tikri village on 1 February 2026, promoting awareness about education, healthcare and community welfare while bringing together parents, students and teachers from government schools. The event was graced by Mr. Abhishek Kumar Dhoble, Counsellor of the Social Service Council, and saw the participation of over 40 parents and more than 120 volunteers. The mela featured stalls on academic awareness, educational opportunities, government schemes, science exhibition, extracurricular activities, parental, social and digital awareness. A medical stall organized in collaboration with IMS BHU also provided free medical check-ups and medicines to the residents of Tikri village.

Faculty Updates



We are pleased to share that Dr. Shivam Awasthi who completed his PhD in Physics from IIT (BHU), Varanasi has been awarded the prestigious Marie Sklodowska-Curie Fellowship. His proposal received an outstanding score of 98.2% in the Physics category, reflecting the excellence of his research. This remarkable achievement brings pride to the institute and serves as an inspiration for students and young researchers to pursue careers in scientific research.

Alumni Registrations



The alumni can now connect with their fellow batchmates by simply registering themselves on the official alumni portal created by the office of Dean (Resource & Alumni Affairs).

Registering on the portal will allow the alumni to stay connected with their alma mater through updates about the various developments at their beloved Institute.

Click/Scan QR code

Alumni Giving Back Portal

IIT (BHU) has witnessed rapid growth in the past years, facilitated by kind donations from our alumni. Realizing the importance of this support, the Institute has its dedicated giving back portal, where Indian alumni may contribute to the progress of their alma mater as per their choice.

All donations by the Indian Alumni to IIT (BHU), Varanasi are exempted from U/S 80G of the I-Tax Act of the Government of India. NRI Alumni may contribute to a different bank account per the information provided on the giving back portal.

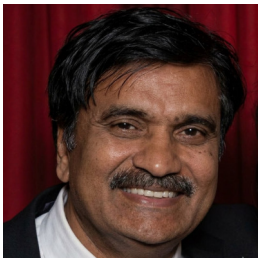
Alumni Updates

Student Alumni Interaction Cell



In the month of February, the **Student Alumni Interaction Cell** directed their efforts towards mentorship and informing through interaction. As a step, the cell in collaboration with Prastuti '26, hosted an Interactive Guest Talk with Sh. Vani Dantam (MET '79), Founder & CEO of Dantam Energy within the domain of Defence Technology and Energy. And under the Student Alumni Mentorship Program, in the 'One on One Mentorship Program', 150 students were mentored and connected by 130 alumni through 115+ meets in various domains like Software Development, DA & DS, Civil Services and many more.

Alumni Contributions



Sh. Venkataramana Mukkapati (ECE '86) has generously pledged and donated USD 115,000 for establishing the 'Above and Beyond Fund,' aimed at supporting undergraduate students in attending international conferences, hackathons, and internships, enabling exploration of global opportunities.



The Batch of 1976, commemorating their Golden Jubilee Reunion, donated Rs. 60,00,000 for establishing the 'Product Design and Virtual Prototyping Lab 1976 Kernel,' under the *GuruDakshina* Project which will provide advanced facilities to enhance innovation and hands on learning at IIT (BHU), Varanasi.

This alumni-led initiative coordinated by AASSII proposes the creation of a modular virtual prototyping lab at IIT (BHU). Designed as a scalable, multi-year effort, the project combines alumni funding and industry expertise to support multidisciplinary collaboration across departments. The lab will allow students to work on real-world, industry-aligned projects using digital prototyping and simulation tools. By starting with a working prototype, the initiative aims to validate the model and pave the way for a larger future infrastructure project while significantly enhancing students' practical exposure, innovation, and industry readiness.

Seasonal Lines

Basant aaya, hariyali chhayi Banaras Hindu University ke aangan mein,
Lanka Gate se guzri pawan, phoolon ki mehek liye har ek chaman mein.
Vishwanath Temple ke paas gunje komal si basanti dhun,
Har path, har vriksh kahe — phir jee utha BHU ka aangan sun.
Margon par dhoop ne sona sa rang bikhera,
Hostelon ke anganon mein yaadon ka geet phir se ghera.
Ganga ki thandi lahrein le aayi smritiyon ka saar,
Basant phusphusaya — yahan gyaan aur sapnon ka hai sansar.

BACK TO CAMPUS

- Some places never leave you they simply wait for you to return...

In February 2026, IIT (BHU) warmly welcomed back two distinguished alumni batches for their milestone reunions. The Class of 1986 gathered on campus from 1 to 4 February, revisiting their departments, reconnecting with faculty and friends, and experiencing the timeless charm of Varanasi through temple visits, a serene Ganga cruise with the evening Aarti, and cultural performances along the ghats. Further in the month, the Class of 1976 returned in the campus to celebrate their Golden Jubilee from 25 to 27 February, marking fifty years since graduation with heartfelt tributes to teachers, nostalgic campus walks, and lively conversations that bridged decades. A highlight of the celebrations was a spirited friendly cricket match, bringing out the same camaraderie and competitive spirit that once filled the institute grounds. Walking through the institute, alumni revisited familiar corridors, classrooms, and landmarks that shaped their formative years, reliving memories that time had only deepened. From Banarasi breakfasts and cultural evenings to music, dinners, and shared memories, both reunions beautifully celebrated enduring friendships and the lifelong bond alumni share with their alma mater.

Batch of 1976







Batch of 1986

> From 1976 we followed different paths and have grown older, but today I feel as fresh as in March 1971 when we joined IT-BHU. We left IT-BHU, but IT-BHU has never left us. Fond memories abound.
>
> -Mr. Subodh Kumar Rai (MET '76)

> It is a rare golden milestone, celebrating 40 years of friendship, professional growth and shared memories that have survived time and distance. Cheers to IIT BHU batch of 86!
>
> -Mr. Shiv Shukla (CHE '86)

> Five decades of memories, friendships and journey. Grateful to reconnect with warm hearts. The IIT BHU spirit lives on. Super reunion and bonding. Kudos to the people who made it possible.
>
> -Mr. Sunil Khanna (EEE '76)

SAIC is grateful to the Director, Dean (Resource & Alumni), Alumni Associations, and the entire IIT (BHU) fraternity for their constant support and blessings. We look forward to your valuable feedback. To share information for future editions, reach us at alumnicell@iitbhu.ac.in.

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